

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN DANCE

MODULE - 4

FOLK DANCE FORMS

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

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KUMMI



- Kummi is a popular folk dance in the region of Tamil Nadu and Kerala.
- The dance is performed by the women, standing in a circular formation.
- A unique feature of the dance performance is the **absence** of any accompanying music.

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KUMMI



- The beats are generated by the **rhythmic clapping**.
- The dance is generally performed during Pongal and other religious festivities.
- **Kolattam and Pinnal Kolattam** are close variants of this dance form.

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MAYILATTAM



- Mayilattam is a folk dance of Kerala and Tamil Nadu in which young girls are dressed as **peacocks**, with **colourful headgears, beaks and feathers**.
- It is also known as peacock dance.
- Similar dances include Kaalai Attam (bull dance), Karadi Attam (bear dance), Aali Attam (demon dance), and Pampu Attam (snake dance).

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BIHU



- Biyu is the popular dance of Assam, performed in group by both men and women.
- The dancers are dressed in colourful traditional dresses to celebrate the pomp and gaiety.
- The dance performance includes group formations, rapid hand movements and brisk footsteps.

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SINGHI CHHAM



- The Singhi Chham is a popular **mask dance of Sikkim**.
- It is a dance of the Bhutia people.
- The dancers are dressed in furry costumes, **symbolising the snow lion** and pay tribute to Khang-Chen Dzong Pa (Kanchenjunga Peak) which is sacred to this people.

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THANG TA



- Thang Ta is the exclusive martial dance form of Manipur.
- Thang means sword and Ta means spear.
- The dance performance is a unique display of skill, creativity and agility in which the performers enact a mock fight sequence – leaping to attack and defend.

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CHERAW DANCE



- Most of the dances of Mizoram are performed during the time of festival.
- Generally, these folk dances are group dances.
- Cheraw dance is most popularly known as '**Bamboo dance**'.
- Bamboos are used in the performance of the dance, from which the dance is named so.
- Both men and women come together & perform the **bamboo dance** of Mizoram.

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CHERAW DANCE



- While the men hold the bamboos, the women folk dance between the bamboos.
- In the performance, the dancer moves by stepping alternatively in and out from between and across a pair of horizontal bamboos.
- People mostly sitting in facing to either side hold these bamboos against the ground.
- People in a sitting position, tap the bamboos, open and close it as per the rhythmic beats.

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CHERAW DANCE



Source: Youtube

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CHERAW DANCE



- Two bases support the bamboos that are placed horizontally, one at each end.
- The movements created by bamboos at the time of clapping produce a sharp sound.
- This particular sound forms the rhythm of the dance.
- It also indicates the timing for the dancing steps as well.

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CHERAW DANCE



- The dancers perform various attractive steps in and out on the beats of the bamboos.
- Generally, the patterns and stepping of the dance have many variations that are very much graceful.
- Sometimes the stepping are made in imitation of the movements of birds, sometimes to show the swaying of trees, and it goes on.

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JAWARA



- Jawara is the harvest dance popular in the Bundelkhand region of Madhya Pradesh.
- The dance, which includes balancing a basketfull of jawar on the head, is accompanied by a heavy instrumental music.

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MATKI



- Matki is performed by the women of **Malwa region** on the occasions of wedding and other festivities.
- It is mainly performed by **balancing a number of earthen pots on the head**.
- Aada and khada Nach are popular variants of the Matki dance.

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GAUR MARIA

- 1 Gaur Maria is an important ritualistic dance form of the **Bison Horn Maria tribes** who live in the Bastar region of Chhattisgarh.



- 2 The dance imitates the movements of a bison and is performed in group by both men and women.



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ALKAP



- Alkap is a rural dance-drama performance prevalent in the **Rajmahal hills** of **Jharkhand** and **Rajshahi**, **Murshidabad** and **Malda** regions of **West Bengal**.
- It is performed by troops of 10-12 dancers, accompanied by one or two lead singers known as **gayens**.
- The troops perform popular folk lore and mythological stories, in which the dance is interspersed with **comical sketches** known as **kaap**.
- The dance is generally associated with the **Gajan festival** of **Shiva**.

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JAT-JATIN



- Jat-Jatin is popular in the northern parts of Bihar, especially in the regions of Mithila.
- This dance form is unique in its representation of the tender love and quarrel of a married couple.

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PAIKA



- Paika is a **martial folk dance** performed in the southern parts of Bihar.
- The dancers are armed with wooden spears and shields, and show off their skills and agility in infantry like formations.

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DANDA-JATRA



In order to achieve closeness to God, a lot of punishments, Danda, is undergone by the individual, so this event is known as Danda Nata

- The Danda Nata or the Danda Jatra is one of the oldest folk arts of India.
- It is popular in Odisha, mainly in the Ganjam district, it is a unique blend of dance, drama and music.

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BURRAKATHA



- Burrakatha or Jangam Katha, is a form of dance narration from Andhra Pradesh, in which a single performer narrates stories from the puranas.

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24 BUTTA BOMMALU



- Butta Bommalu literally means **basket toys** and is a **popular dance** form of the **West Godavari district** of **Andhra Pradesh**.
- The dancers wear masks of different characters, resembling toy like shapes, and entertain through delicate movements and non-verbal music.

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KAIKOTTIKALI



- Kaikottikali, also known as Thiruvathirakali, is a popular art form of Kerala.
- It is mainly performed by women at the time of Onam to celebrate the rich harvest.
- Airukali and Tattamakali are similar forms of this dance.

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PADAYANI



- Padayani is a martial dance performed in the temples of southern Kerala.
- Padayani literally means rows of infantry, and it's a very rich and colourful affair.
- The dancers wear huge masks known as kolams, and present interpretations of divine and semi divine narratives.
- Some of the popular characters are Bhairavi, Kalan (god of death), Yakshi etc.

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27 KOLKALI-PARICHAKALI



- It is a popular martial dance in the areas of southern Kerala and Lakshadweep.
- Kol means stick and Paricha means shield.
- The dancers use mock weapons made of wood and enact fight sequences.
- The performance starts at a slow pace, but slowly builds up the tempo and climaxes in a frenzy.

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BHOOTHA ARADHANE

- 1 Bhootha Aradhane or devil worship is a popular dance form of Karnataka.



- 2 Prior to the performance, idols depicting devils are placed on a plinth and the performer then dances vigorously, as if he is a possessed person.



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PATA KUNITHA



- It is the dance form popular in the Mysore region.
- It is primarily a religious dance performed by men who use long bamboo poles decorated with colourful ribbons, known as pata.
- The colourful exuberance makes it a visual spectacle and is extremely popular among the masses of all religion.
- Puja Kunitha is a variant of this dance form popular in the region around Bengaluru and Mandya districts.

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